MAJOR OBJECTIVES OF NAM

The leaders of 25 non-aligned countries met at the Belgrade Conference in 1961 to create an independent path in world politics that would shield them from becoming pawns in the struggle between the major powers. Their common concerns became the fundamental principles upon which the non-aligned countries based their decisions and activities. They are a commitment to:

- Peace and disarmament, especially the reduction of tensions between the major powers.
- Independence, including the right of self-determination of all colonial peoples and the right of equality between all races.
- Economic equality, with an emphasis on restructuring the existing international economic order, particularly with respect to the growing and persistent inequality between the rich and the poor nations.
- Cultural equality, with an emphasis on restructuring the world information and communication order, and opposing cultural imperialism and the Western monopoly of information systems.
- Universalism and multilateralism through strong support for the United Nations system.[10]

These principles have been the underlying guidelines of the Movement from its beginning, and no attempt was formally made to enunciate them until the Sixth Summit in Havana in 1979. It should be noted at this point that though the non-aligned countries share a commitment to these basic principles, there are ideological differences within the Movement as the Movement is a complex grouping of states representing different histories, languages, religions and cultures and a variety of political, social and economic systems. These differences sometimes have come to influence the course of the Movement, but it can be said that despite such tendencies the Movement continues to reflect one single primary concern—to engage in policies that reduce structural inequality in